



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2023-24
HALF YEARLY EXAMINATION

CLASS: X
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER I (SETA)

FULL MARKS: 80
TIME: 2 HOURS

Answers to this Paper must be written on the paper provided separately.

You will not be allowed to write during the first 15 minutes.

This time is to be spent in reading the question paper.

The time given at the head of this Paper is the time allowed for writing the answers.

Attempt all five questions.

The intended marks for questions or parts of questions are given in brackets [].

This paper consists of eight printed pages.

Question 1

Write a composition (300-350 words) on any one of the following:

[20]

- i) Write an original story entitled "The Unforgettable Adventure".
- ii) You went to the vegetable and fish market in your locality with your elder sibling last Sunday. Describe the sights, sounds and smells that you had experienced there.
- iii) 'More life lessons are learnt in the sports field than in the classroom'. Express your views either for or against this statement.
- iv) The day before the examination, you found your school bag containing your books and copies missing. Give an account of your feelings and explain how you dealt with the situation. What did you learn from the experience?

- v) Study the picture given below. Write a story or a description or an account of what it suggests to you. Your composition may be about the subject of the picture or you may take suggestions from it; however, there must be a clear connection between the picture and your composition.



Question 2

Select any one of the following:

[10]

- i) Your class wants to visit an orphanage near your school and donate some clothes to the children there. Write a letter to the Principal of your school seeking permission and mentioning the reason for the visit. Mention how you would like to spend the day with the children and how this visit would benefit your classmates.
- ii) You were a part of the organizing committee of an Inter-House Debate Competition which was successfully conducted in your school. You and the other committee members were congratulated and praised at the School Assembly. Write a letter to your grandmother describing the event and mentioning your feelings at being praised in front of everyone. Also share what you learnt from the duty that had been assigned to you.

Question 3

- i) You are a member of the Students' Council. Write a notice for your school notice board, inviting students of classes IX to X to give their names for an Inter-School Chess Competition, to be held at your school. [5]
- ii) Write an e-mail to the Principal of your neighbouring school requesting him/her to send a team of two participants to take part in the Inter-School Chess Competition.[5]

Question 4

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

They pass me everyday, on their way to school—boys and girls from the surrounding villages and the outskirts of the hill station. There are no school buses plying for these children: they walk.

For many of them, it's a very long walk to school.

Ranbir, who is ten, has to climb the mountain from his village, four miles distant and two thousand feet below the town level. He comes in all weathers, wearing the same pair of cheap shoes until they have almost fallen apart.

Ranbir is a cheerful soul. He waves to me whenever he sees me at my window. Sometimes he brings me cucumbers from his father's field. I pay him for the cucumbers; he uses the money for books or for small things needed at home.

Many of the children are like Ranbir—poor, but slightly better off than what their parents were at the same age. They cannot attend the expensive residential and private schools that abound here, but must go to the government aided schools with only basic facilities. Not many of their parents managed to go to school. They spent their lives working in the fields or delivering milk in the hill station. The lucky ones got into the army. Perhaps Ranbir will do something different when he grows up.

He has yet to see a train but he sees planes flying over the mountains almost every day.

“How far can a plane go?” he asks.

“All over the world,” I tell him. “Thousands of miles in a day. You can go almost anywhere.”

“I'll go round the world one day,” he vows. “I'll buy a plane and go everywhere!”

And may be he will. He has a determined chin and a defiant look in his eye. Upto a few years ago, very few girls in the hills or in the villages of India went to school. They helped in the home until they were old enough to be married, which wasn't very old. But there are now just as many girls as there are boys going to school.

Bindra is something of an extrovert—confident fourteen year old who chatters away as she hurries down the road with her companions. Her father is a forest guard and knows me quite well: I meet him on my walks through the deodar woods behind Landour. And I had grown used to seeing Bindra almost every day. When she did not put in an appearance for a week, I asked her brother if anything was wrong.

“Oh, nothing,” he says, “She is helping my mother cut grass. Soon the monsoon will end and the grass will dry up. So we cut it now and store it for the cows in winter.”

“And why aren’t you cutting grass too?”

“Oh, I have a cricket match today,” he says, and hurries away to join his team mates. Unlike his sister, he puts pleasure before work!

Cricket, once the game of the elite has become the game of the masses. On any holiday, in any part of this vast country, groups of boys can be seen making their way to the nearest field, or open patch of land, with bat, ball and any other cricketing gear that they can cobble together. Watching some of them play; I am amazed at the quality of talent, at the finesse with which they bat or bowl. Some of the local teams are as good, if not better, than any from the private schools, where there are better facilities. But boys from these poor or lower middle-class families will never get the exposure that is necessary to bring them to the attention of those who select state or national teams. They will never get near enough to the men of influence and power. They must continue to play for the love of the game, or watch their more fortunate heroes’ exploits on television.

- i) For each word given below choose the correct meaning (as used in the passage) from the options provided: [2]

1. *extrovert*

- a) shy nature
- b) outgoing
- c) repulsive
- d) reluctant

2. *elite*

- a) crowd
- b) aristocrat
- c) inferior
- d) best

- ii) Which word in the passage means the opposite of the word cheap? [1]

- a) cobble
- b) influence
- c) finesse
- d) expensive

iii) Answer the following questions briefly in your words:

- a) Which sentence in the passage tells us that Ranbir's school was far from his village? [2]
- b) What was Ranbir's ambition? [2]
- c) How had the fate of the girls changed? [2]
- d) Bindra is a little different when compared to her brother. What kind of a person do you think she was? [2]
- e) How would you feel if you were not being recognised despite your sporting talent? [1]

iv) In not more than 50 words, point out how the author portrays the difficulties that the children in the village face in their daily lives. [8]

Question 5

- i) Fill in each of the numbered blanks with the correct form of the word given in brackets. Do not copy the passage but write in correct serial order the word or phrase appropriate to the blank space. Example: (0): distinguished [4]

A splendid young man who had ____ (0) (distinguish) himself earlier, ____ (1) (step) lightly down the lane as the grey bull ____ (2) (pass) him and reached out for the cloth. The bull ____ (3) (turn) in a flash, the young man ____ (4) (leap) back from the quick, sideways toss of the horns, and the bull ____ (5) (continue) its sauntering way down the lane. Only when the man ____ (6) (collapse) on the fence and was helped out of the lane, did we ____ (7) (realise) that the bull ____ (8) (injure) the man.

ii) Fill in the blanks with appropriate words: [4]

- a) He is proficient _____ music.
- b) The swimmers were asked to dive _____ the pool.
- c) The team gave _____ without a fight.
- d) Can you distribute the pens _____ your classmates?
- e) The hunter aimed _____ the deer and pulled the trigger.
- f) The authorities should not discriminate _____ the rich and the poor.
- g) We were forced to comply _____ the recommendations of the committee.
- h) It has been twenty years _____ she graduated from college.

iii) Join the following sentences to make one complete sentence without using *and*, *but* or *so*. Choose the correct option. [4]

1. I wear the suit very sparingly. I got it two years back.

- a) Although I got the suit two years back, I don't wear it sparingly.
- b) I wear the suit two years back very sparingly.
- c) I wear the suit very sparingly for I got it three years back.
- d) Although I got the suit two years back, I wear it very sparingly.

2. She was very nervous about her examination. She could not sleep at night.

- a) As she was very nervous about her examination, she could not sleep at night.
- b) Her examination made her nervous and gave sleepless night.
- c) She was very nervous about her examination, as she couldn't sleep at night.
- d) She couldn't sleep at night as she had the examination.

3. The child is weak. He is very active.

- a) Despite the child being weak, he is very active.
- b) Despite being a child, he is very active.
- c) Despite of the child being weak, he is very active
- d) Despite the child's weakness, she is very active.

4. Ravindra is not in the classroom. He is not in the laboratory.

- a) Neither is Ravindra in the classroom nor in the laboratory.
- b) Neither Ravindra is in the classroom nor in the laboratory.
- c) Ravindra is not in the classroom nor in the laboratory.
- d) Ravindra is not in the classroom and laboratory.

iv) Re-write the following sentences according to the instructions given after each. Make other changes that may be necessary but do not change the meaning of each sentence. Choose the correct options. [8]

1. The boy was so nervous that he could not perform. (Use: too)

- a) The boy was too nervous to not perform.
- b) The boy was too nervous to perform.
- c) The boy was too nervous, therefore he could not perform.
- d) The boy was too nervous before he could perform.

- 2. The Principal said, "All the prizes will be distributed tomorrow" (Begin: The Principal said that....)**
- a) The Principal said that all the prizes will be distributed the next day.**
 - b) The Principal said that all the prizes would be distributed the previous day.**
 - c) The Principal said that all the prizes will be distributed the next day.**
 - d) The Principal said that all the prizes would be distributed the next day.**
- 3. The team won the match for its resilience. (Use: resilient.)**
- a) The resilient team won the match.**
 - b) As the team was resilient, they won the match.**
 - c) The team won the match with resilient.**
 - d) The resilient of the team made them winner.**
- 4. If Narayani catches the first bus, she will be on time for school. (Begin: Unless)**
- a) Unless Narayani catches the first bus, she will be on time for school.**
 - b) Unless she is on time for school, Narayani catches the first bus.**
 - c) Unless Narayani catches the first bus, she will not be on time for school.**
 - d) Unless she catches the first bus, Narayani will not be on time for school.**
- 5. The coaches have trained their players well. (Begin: The players...)**
- a) The players had been trained well by their coaches.**
 - b) The players have been trained well by their coaches.**
 - c) The players had trained well for their coaches.**
 - d) The players were trained well by their coaches.**
- 6. I would rather drink tea than coffee. (Use: prefer)**
- a) I prefer to have tea than coffee.**
 - b) I prefer not to have coffee but tea.**
 - c) I prefer tea to coffee.**
 - d) I prefer tea over coffee.**

- 7. Hardly had the teacher left the room when all the children started making a noise. (Begin: No sooner....)**
- a) No sooner had the teacher left the room when all the children started making a noise.**
 - b) No sooner had the teacher left the room then all the children were starting to make a noise.**
 - c) No sooner had the teacher left the room than all the children started making a noise.**
 - d) No sooner did the teacher left the room than all the children started making a noise.**
- 8. This is the best pastry I have ever eaten. (Begin: Never...)**
- a) Never have I eaten a pastry as good as this.**
 - b) Never I have eaten a good pastry as this.**
 - c) Never has a pastry that I have eaten tasted this good.**
 - d) Never have I eaten a pastry like this.**